# 02. Rainforest Run

Comet Cup · upgrade blueprint · src/kart/tracks/jungle.ts

## Where it is now

2.9 km: river village, rope bridge or ford, waterfall ledge, switchbacks, canopy walkway, glide to the temple, temple tunnel with a sliding trap.

## What is wrong

The river and jungle are backdrops. You drive a road past them.

## Core mechanic

The river is part of the track. Long stretches are driven in the river itself, where the current pushes you downstream (sideways or forwards). Deep mud ruts grab the wheels and steer the car along them.

## Signature moments

- Vine swing: the kart hooks a vine and swings across a gorge; when you release decides where you land (a high fast line or a low safe one).
- River run: a section driven down the river with the current, rocks to avoid, and rapids that throw you up.
- The drop off the waterfall ledge into the pool below as a short cut.

## Layout changes

- Keep the village, switchbacks and temple.
- Replace the ford with a proper river section (300-400 m) with current.
- Add the vine-swing gorge as a fork against the rope bridge.

## Lap changes

- Lap 2: rain, the mud ruts deepen and spread onto the road.
- Last lap: the river rises; the river run becomes a fast current lane and the low bank road floods.

## Engine work needed

- Force zones: river current and rapids.
- Mud ruts that pull the steering.
- Locked-on rail/swing: the vine swing (attach, swing, release).

## Rivals

- Rivals release the vine at a chosen point.
- Rivals steer against or with the current.

## Done when

- Laps of 50-60 s for a good driver; all 3-lap test races finish with no errors.
- Rivals use every route and the core mechanic, with no more than 2 rival falls per race.
- The core mechanic is in play for at least half the lap, not just one set piece.
- A blind test: a screenshot or a 10-second clip of this track could not be mistaken for any other track.
- Item rows are never on the start line; nothing solid blocks a road by accident.